



August 18, 2025

The Honorable Jamieson Greer
United States Trade Representative
Office of the U.S. Trade Representative
600 17th Street, NW
Washington, DC 20508

Docket No. USTR-2025-0043 for “Request for Comments on the Section 301 Investigation of Act, Policies, and Practices of Brazil Related to Digital Trade and Electronic Payment Services; Unfair, Preferential Tariffs; Anti-Corruption Enforcement; Intellectual Property Protection; Ethanol Market Access; and Illegal Deforestation.”

Dear Ambassador Greer,

The National Coffee Association of USA (NCA) represents the entire U.S. coffee value chain, comprising more than 200 members who operate in every U.S. state and territory and range from major consumer brands to coffee importers, exporters, traders, brokers, roasters, retailers, and allied organizations.

Summary

As the Section 301 Committee investigates Brazil’s act, policies and practices to determine whether they are actionable under Section 301, the NCA would like to take this opportunity to highlight the significance of bilateral trade in coffee to the U.S. coffee drinkers, U.S. workers, and the U.S. economy.

We are confident that the Section 301 Committee will find coffee is not a product of unfair or non-reciprocal trade but rather an essential product (with minimal domestic production) that drives the U.S. economy, supports nearly 2.2 million U.S. jobs, and delivers proven health benefits while fueling American consumers’ daily lives.

For these reasons, we strongly urge the administration to remove coffee from existing and proposed tariffs or trade restrictions under review, given the absence of domestic alternatives to coffee imports and the devastating impact coffee tariffs would have on U.S. coffee drinkers, U.S. coffee workers, and the U.S. economy.

There is no domestic alternative to coffee imports

Two-thirds of American adults drink coffee each day (73% each week),¹ making it more popular than any other beverage (including tap or bottled water). Drinking coffee is also associated with significantly reduced risk of multiple cancers and chronic diseases – one reason President Trump’s administration formally recognized plain coffee as “healthy” in April 2025.²

The United States cannot grow coffee domestically, except for a small amount of coffee grown in Hawaii and Puerto Rico. As a result, the United States must import over 99% of the coffee Americans consume in

¹2024 National Coffee Data Trends Fall Edition, Page 19; The National Coffee Association of USA

²<https://www.fda.gov/food/workshops-meetings-webinars-food-and-dietary-supplements/webinar-updated-healthy-claim-04102025>

the form of unroasted coffee beans (“green coffee”), roasted coffee, instant and soluble coffee, including the decaffeinated versions of these coffees.

Historically, coffee imports in all these categories have entered the United States duty-free, with these imports serving as the first step in a thriving and high value-add U.S. coffee economy that supports more than 2.2 million U.S. jobs and contributes more than \$343 billion to the U.S. economy through investments, distribution, retail, and marketing activities. For every one dollar in coffee imported, we estimate that \$43 in domestic economic activity results.³

Any disruption in imports puts high-value U.S. processing, production, and manufacturing at risk and could divert that tremendous value to other countries like China who are eager to grow their own industries.

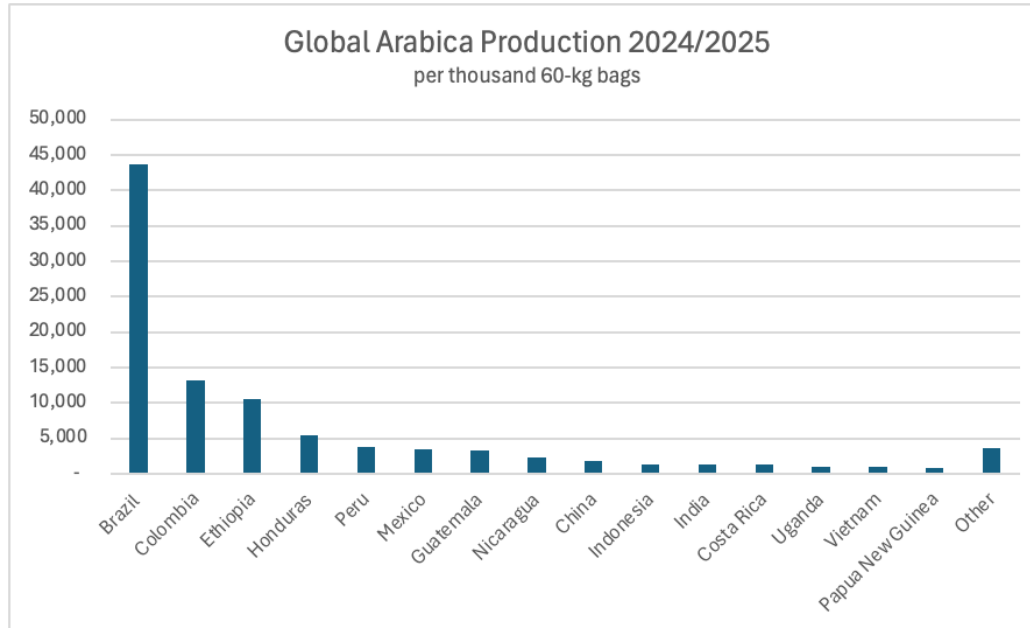
Brazil is the world’s largest supplier of coffee

As a country with a climate suitable to growing coffee, Brazil is the largest coffee producer in the world by far. Per USDA’s biannual report on world coffee markets and trade⁴, Brazil produced 64.7 million bags of coffee in 2024/2025, more than 37% of global coffee produced, and more than twice as much as the second largest coffee producing country (Vietnam - 16.6%). Brazil produces more coffee than the combined total of the second to fifth largest global coffee suppliers (Vietnam, Colombia, Ethiopia and Indonesia).

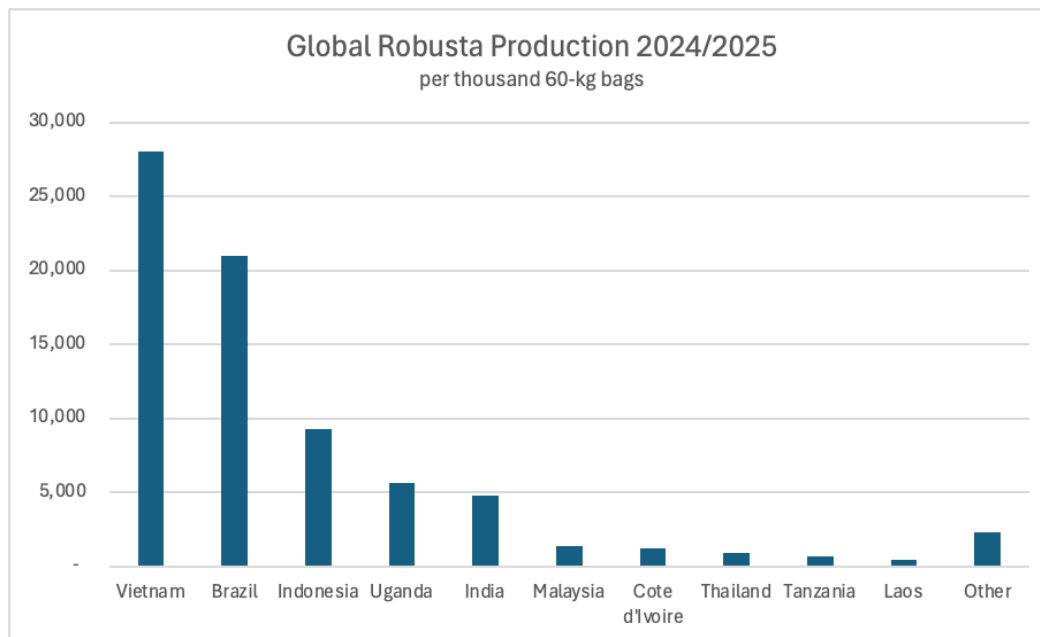
Brazil ranks as the largest global supplier of arabica beans (43.7 million bags in 2024/2025) and the second largest producer of robusta beans (21 million bags in 2024/2025).

³ U.S. Coffee Economic Impact Report at <https://www.ncausa.org/Advocacy/Economic-Impact>

⁴ Coffee: World Markets and Trade at <https://www.fas.usda.gov/sites/default/files/2025-06/coffee.pdf>

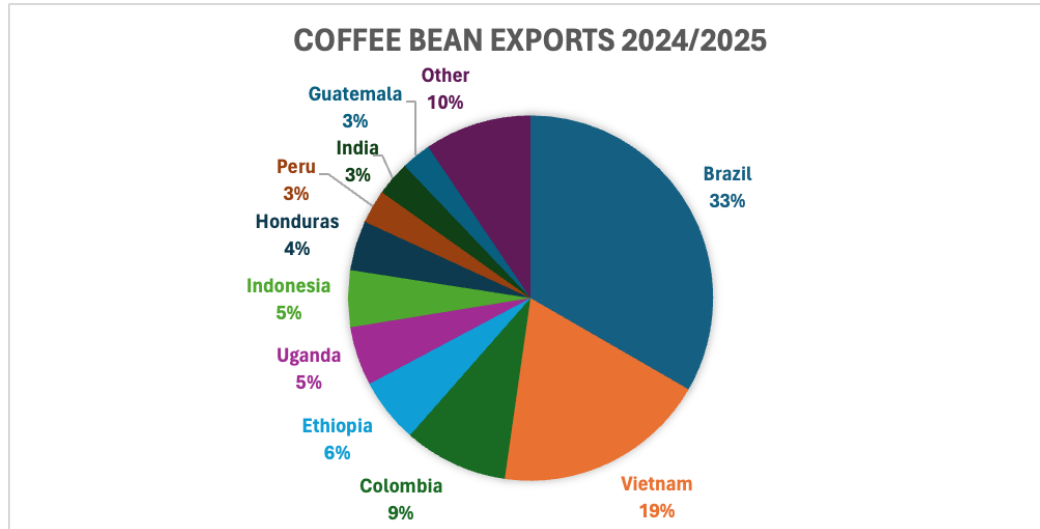


USDA Coffee: World Markets and Trade Report June 2025

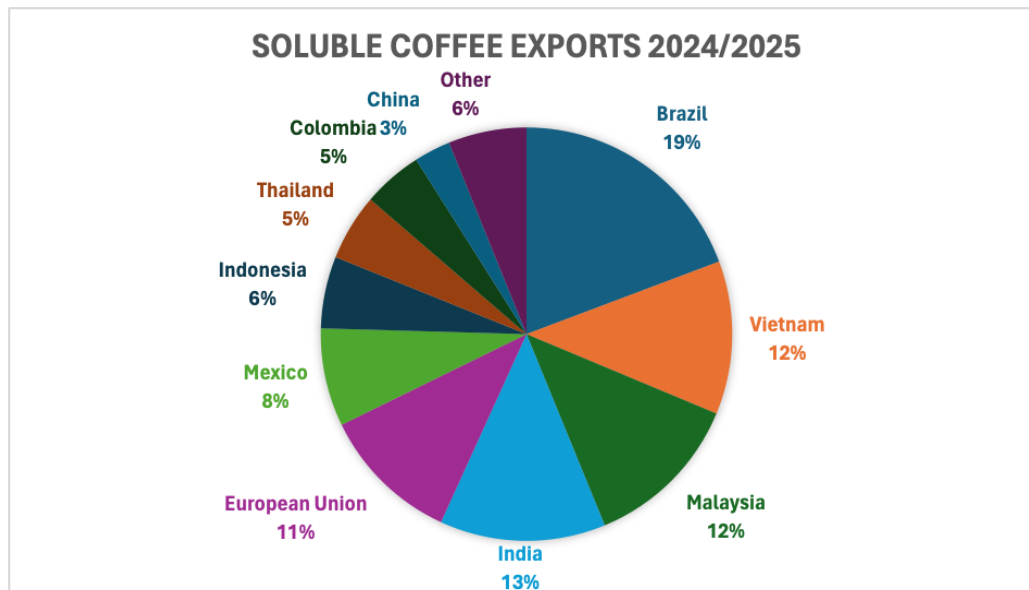


USDA Coffee: World Markets and Trade Report June 2025

Brazil ranks as the world's largest exporter of coffee beans - 33% of all coffee exported globally. Brazil also ranks as the world's largest exporter of soluble coffee, used for instant coffee and coffee extracts.



USDA Coffee: World Markets and Trade Report June 2025

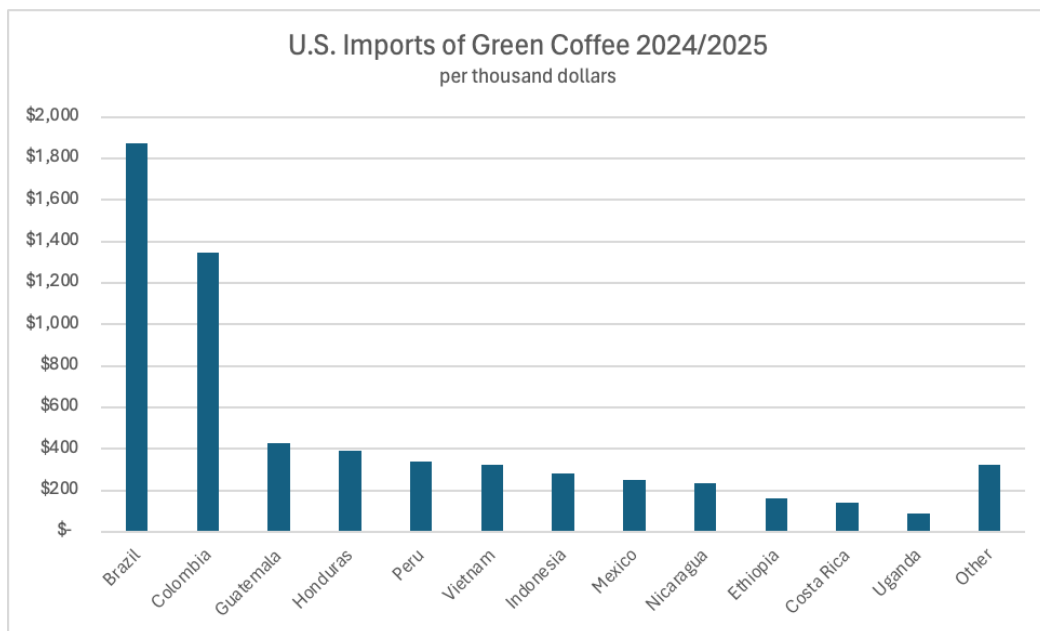


USDA Coffee: World Markets and Trade Report June 2025

Coffee imports from Brazil fuel the U.S. economy

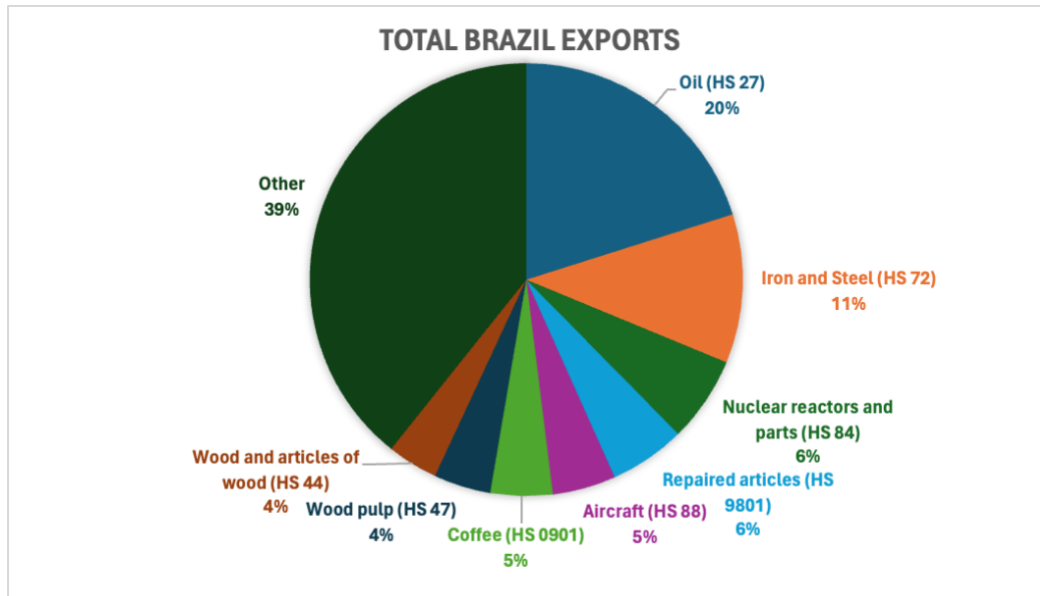
In 2024, the United States imported more than \$9.8 billion of coffee - 68% green coffee (HTS 0901.11 and 0901.12), 22% roasted coffee (HTS 0901.21 and 0901.22), and 10% instant coffee and coffee extracts (HTS 2101.11 and 2102.12).⁵ Brazil is the top source for U.S. imports of raw, unroasted (“green”) coffee.

About 30%-40% of the green coffee consumed in the United States is from Brazil. At the same time, coffee accounted for just 5% of Brazil’s exports to the United States in 2024.



USITC Dataweb

⁵ U.S. International Trade Commission DataWeb



U.S. Census trade data 2024

Imports of coffee from Brazil cannot be substituted from other countries since Brazil is the largest coffee producer globally.

U.S. coffee businesses and coffee drinkers have no option but to rely on imported green coffee grown in Brazil and, to a lesser degree, in other countries with suitable climates.

In recent years, fluctuating coffee harvests and increased demand from countries like China are among the factors that have already increased the price of a pound of coffee by almost 102% over the last 5 years and by 20% since January 2025.⁶ In just the last year, the price of every cup of coffee has increased by almost 15%.⁷

Diversion of coffee supply to other countries would harm U.S. interests

U.S. tariffs on green coffee beans will severely disadvantage U.S. roasters and the value coffee adds to the U.S. economy.

Brazilian coffee will likely be increasingly exported to other countries, including China, the European Union, Switzerland, Canada, and Mexico, instead of to the United States - undermining this important value-added food processing sector in the United States. According to reports, China recently approved 183 new Brazilian coffee companies to export products to the Chinese market.⁸

⁶ Federal Reserve Bank of St. Louis [Average coffee price](#) in U.S. average city

⁷ Federal Reserve Bank of St. Louis [CPI](#) for urban coffee prices

⁸ <https://www.reuters.com/world/china/china-welcomes-183-brazil-coffee-sellers-wake-us-tariffs-2025-08-03>

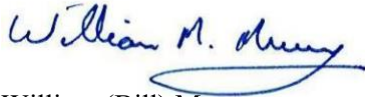
High tariffs on green coffee beans from Brazil could create a tariff inversion scenario, where the tariff rate on the raw material is higher than the tariff rate on the finished goods made from that material. Coffee roasters in third markets could undercut U.S. roasters by using lower-cost green coffee beans from Brazil and then exporting roasted coffee blends to the United States at significantly lower prices than U.S. roasters would be able to compete with.

After the raw commodity arrives in the United States, the value added in the supply chain comes here, where green coffee beans are stored, cleaned, shipped, roasted, packed, marketed, prepared, and sold. This value-add would be at risk if the raw commodity is shipped elsewhere due to tariffs, with a direct impact on U.S. coffee roasters.

Conclusion

In order to continue providing the over 220 million American coffee drinkers and support the U.S. coffee industry, imports of all coffee - HTS 0901, 2101.11, and 2102.12 - should be removed from tariffs applied to Brazil.

Sincerely,

A handwritten signature in blue ink that reads "William M. Murray". The signature is fluid and cursive, with a long horizontal stroke at the end.

William (Bill) Murray
President & CEO
National Coffee Association of USA